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Brief Bio: K. Ullas Karanth

Kota Ullas Karanth was originally trained as a mechanical engineer at the National Institute of Technology, Surathkal (1971), but changed careers pursue his deep passion for wildlife biology, obtaining an MS degree from the University of Florida, USA (1988) and a PhD from Mangalore University, India (1993).

Dr. Ullas Karanth is now Emeritus Director of the Centre for Wildlife Studies (CWS) that he founded in 1984. During 1988-2017, he also headed the Wildlife Conservation Society (WCS) India Program. Dr. Karanth has held the positions of an Adjunct Professor at the universities of Florida and Minnesota in the USA and the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research-NCBS, India.

Dr. Karanth has conducted long-term research on the ecology of large carnivores including tigers in India, while also providing his special expertise in animal ecology, population modeling, conservation biology and policy to tiger research programs Asia. Karanth has published over 150 scientific papers in prestigious journals as well as numerous popular articles. He has authored/edited/co-edited several books in English: *The Way of the Tiger* (2001), *Monitoring Tigers and their Prey* (2002), *A view from the Machan* (2006), *Tiger Tales* (2007), *Camera traps in Animal Ecology* (2009), *Science of Saving Tigers* (2011), *Science and Conservation of Animal Populations* (2017) *Methods for Monitoring Tiger and Prey Populations* (2017), *Among Tigers* (2023) as well as memoir about his father, the polymath Kota Shivarama Karanth, titled *Growing up Karanth*. He has also authored /coauthored articles and books on wildlife in Kannada, including *Aranya Mattu Samaja* (1982), *Kaadupranigala Jadinalli* (2001), *Huliya Baduku* and *Hulirayana Akashavaani* (2007).

In recognition of his contributions to wildlife conservation, Dr. Karanth won the Sierra Club's *EarthCare* award (2006), World Wildlife Funds's *J. Paul Getty award* (2007) an the Wildlife Conservation Society's George Schaller Award (2018). Dr. Karanth is a Fellow of the Indian Academy of Sciences (2008), and has been conferred the *Karnataka Rajya Prashashti* (2011), the Presidential award *Padma Shri* (2012). He is a has been recognized as a *Distinguished Alumnus* by the St. Aloysius College, Mangalore, the National Institute of Technology, Surathkal and the University of Florida, Gainesville, USA (2022).

Dr. Karanth serves on the World Conservation Union's specialist groups on Cats, Bears, Elephants, Wild Cattle and Small Carnivores, and has in the past served on

Indian Government's Forest Advisory Committee, National Tiger Conservation Authority and Governing Council of the Wildlife Institute of India. He has been active in conservation serving on the boards of WWF-India and the Liz Claiborne Foundation, New York.

Dr. Karanth's work has been featured in world's media including *Nature*, *Science*, *New Scientist*, *Scientific American*, *New York Times*, *Time Magazine*, *National Geographic*, *BBC*, *CNN*, *PBS*, *CBC*, *Discovery* and *Animal Planet*.

Dr. Karanth (77) lives in Bengaluru, India and is married to Prof. Prathibha Karanth, speech and language pathologist. His daughter, Dr. Krithi Karanth, an Alumna of the Universities of Florida, Yale and Duke, is now the Chief Conservation Scientist at the Centre for Wildlife Studies (CWS), Bengaluru.